Build a BrainLift on Education

Assignment: Choose one focused problem in education and build a BrainLift: an organized body of research that helps you make a better decision. Possible topics include reading instruction, math practice, homework, assessment, or AI tutoring. Narrow your topic to a specific learner group and setting.

---

1. Define your purpose

In 2-3 sentences, state the problem, who it affects, the outcome you want to improve, and the decision your research will inform. Name your boundaries, such as grade level, subject, available time, or resources.

2. Identify experts and sources

Include at least three credible experts or primary sources with different perspectives. For each, provide a direct link, explain its relevance, and record a key finding and its limitations. Read the original sources and verify any citations suggested by AI.

3. Build your knowledge tree

Organize your research into branches using the questions below. Add findings, source links, and unanswered questions under each branch.

- **Problem and learners:** What is going wrong, for whom, and how do we know?
- **Current practice:** What do educators generally recommend? What assumptions support it?
- **Learning and evidence:** How is learning expected to happen? What evidence supports or challenges that explanation, and for which learners?
- **Alternatives:** What other approaches exist, and what are their tradeoffs?
- **Feasibility:** What could fail because of cost, teacher workload, access, motivation, or scale?
- **Measurement:** How would you measure success, including retention or transfer? What result would change your mind?

4. Develop two spiky POVs

A spiky POV is a specific, defensible disagreement with common advice that changes what you would do. For each, state: **the consensus, your counterpoint, supporting evidence and limits, and the practical implication.** Avoid broad claims such as "education needs to change."

5. Pressure-test your POVs with AI

Put each POV into an AI model. Aim for a claim sharp enough that AI will generally disagree with at least one parameter, such as feasibility, cost, scale, or learning impact. Look for a concrete objection: **"This is not viable because of X."** Use this prompt:

> "Evaluate this education POV: [insert POV]. Where is it weak or unlikely to work? Identify the strongest objection, the specific constraint behind it, and the evidence needed to resolve it. Give an honest assessment; do not agree or disagree just because I asked."

Record the strongest objection. Use research to defend, narrow, or revise your POV, and propose one small test. AI disagreement is a useful pressure test, not proof that your claim is correct.

Submit

One document or shared outline containing your **purpose, experts/sources, knowledge tree, two spiky POVs, AI objections, your responses, and a next test.** Strong work is focused, traceable to evidence, and clear about what could prove it wrong.